CWS promises talented line-up for workshop

Renowned Devon-based artist Nick Agar, Pennsylvanian woodturner Michael Kehs and homegrown turner Guilio Marcolongo have been confirmed for 2016's Collaboration Western Australia workshop, which will be held at the end of September.

Under the leadership of Robert Jones and the Committee the Collaboration has flourished and the upcoming event and its invited international guests promises to expand the skills of those attending.

The 2014 Collaboration included Binh Pho and Jacques Vesery who both also held masterclasses before and after the Collaboration. It was four days of hands-on, mind boggling work that were tremendously rewarding and left many people realising how much they still had to learn. Other attendees included Guilio Marcolongo, Neil Turner, Greg Lawrence and Annette Barlow alongside several other well-known Australian artisans.

Funding for the biennial gathering has come from the successful 2014 event, held at Bunbury Cathedral Grammar School. There was also the Coast to Coast exhibition, held at the Bunbury Regional Art Gallery to showcase the work of those attending and other well-known artists.

The 2014 workshop was lively from the off. Within minutes of arriving, everyone was busy and items were being passed around to be worked on by several people. Five days of hard graft followed, punctuated by great camaraderie and friendship and lots of busy fingers at work. By the end of the Collaboration, more than 120 works of art had been made, many of which held no resemblance to the original! During the workshop Binh also gave an evening demonstration and there was a visit to the Bunbury Regional Art Gallery to see the Coast to Coast exhibition. Both Binh and Jacques enjoyed themselves so much they said they would love to be invited back to a future Collaboration in the future.

Essential funding opportunities came in the shape of an eagerly awaited lucky dip, overseen by Jack de Vos, where everyone hoped to win an item made by a guest artists. And on the last afternoon auctioneer Frank Evans held centre stage as more than 130 pieces of work and donated goods went under the hammer.

More information about 2016's event can be found on the Collaboration's website.

Contact: Collaboration Western Australia
Web: www.collaborationwa.org.au

Collaboration Western Australia is a biennial event held in October for a few days of mayhem. It was founded in 2008 by several well-known Western Australian wood artists to enhance the expertise of local and eastern states artists using the unique West Australian timber. The first four-day collaboration was held in April, 2009 with 30 invited artists from all over Australia. They included woodturners, woodcarvers, jewellers and artists. This inaugural event had such positive feedback that it was decided to hold another workshop in July, 2010 and more successful events have followed in the years since. The 2016 workshop is scheduled to run from 22 September.

Irish Yew Bowl by Crataegus, at 159 x 50mm

Table leg pot in oak (*Quercus robur*) at 92mm d x 90mm h, by Neil Lawton

Cocktail Stick Dispensers by CHJ, from ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*) and yew (*Taxus baccata*)

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